

Public Research Replication and Methodology Index

Status labels, data posture, and replication roadmap for the public research library.

Arne Kotte

AUTHOR

Arne Kotte

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Purpose

This page is the trust scaffold for the public research library. It explains what each public document is trying to measure, what data posture it uses, what is already reasonably solid, and what still needs stronger replication or microdata validation.

The goal is to keep the public site readable while preserving clear boundaries between published syntheses, working papers, measurement notes, prototypes, and supporting material.

Status labels

- **Published:** stable public synthesis or product explanation.
- **Working paper:** substantive research draft that may still be revised.
- **Measurement note:** narrow evidence, replication, or methods note.
- **Prototype:** experimental tool or research-to-action surface.
- **Supporting material:** deeper background behind a better starting point.
- **Superseded:** preserved for context, but no longer the preferred entry.

Public research library map

Document	Public status	Primary data posture	What is solid	What remains next
BTC Helper white paper	Published	Product methodology / architecture	Explainable accumulation-regime framing and public/private boundary	Ongoing validation and partner-grade sourcing
Society Under Monetary Stress I: The Fiat Squeeze	Supporting material	Public housing/macro indicators	Housing access requires price, payment, rent-burden, and entry-cash views together	Local/microdata affordability validation
Society Under Monetary Stress II: The Cantillon Map	Supporting material	Public wealth distribution indicators	Asset ownership determines exposure to asset-price regimes	SCF microdata upgrade
Society Under Monetary Stress III: The Quiet Tax	Supporting material	Public essential-cost indicators	Non-deferrable costs can compress household budgets	CEX baskets by household type
Society Under Monetary Stress IV: More Work to Stand Still?	Supporting material	Public labor indicators	Aggregate labor strength can hide household adaptation margins	CPS/ACS microdata on hours and job stacking
Society Under Monetary Stress V: Saving the Future	Supporting material	Public formation/saving indicators	Long-horizon formation margins are vulnerable when recurring costs absorb cash flow	Cohort microdata linking income, debt, formation, and saving
Society Under Monetary Stress VI: Fiscal Space in Daily Life	Supporting material	Public fiscal indicators	Public balance-sheet stress becomes household-relevant through rates, taxes, transfers, services, or inflation	Household/state exposure analysis
Society Under Monetary Stress VII: Borrowed Resilience	Supporting material	Public debt/credit indicators	Credit can bridge shocks but can become borrowed fragility	SHED/NFCS/SCF microdata linking buffers, credit, delinquency, hardship
Society Under Monetary Stress VIII: The Confidence Ledger	Supporting material	Public sentiment/expectations indicators	Planning confidence is a household asset; volatility taxes decisions before bills arrive	Survey microdata linking expectations and behavior

Document	Public status	Primary data posture	What is solid	What remains next
Society Under Monetary Stress IX: The Fragility Premium	Measurement note	Public CPI/CE proxy indicators + CY2024 CEX Interview PUMD appendix	Resilience has recurring costs; selected CY2024 CEX burdens can be measured transparently by income group with BRR uncertainty	Repeated-cross-section CEX/MEPS household-level burden estimates and outcome linkage
Medical Financial Fragility in MEPS	Working paper	2022 MEPS HC microdata + exploratory PRPL	Spending alone is ambiguous; uninsured people can have lower OOP spending but higher access barriers; selected gradients now have approximate design-based CIs	Broader design-based inference, family validation, PRPL annualization/documentation validation, multi-year extension
Emergency Savings and Household Financial Fragility	Measurement note	Public SHED published indicators	\$400 cash/equivalent and three-month savings measures are central buffer diagnostics	SHED public-use microdata models
Emergency Liquidity, Borrowing, and Hardship	Measurement note	SHED 2025 microdata	Buffer weakness, borrowing responses, and hardship outcomes can be studied jointly	Consolidate into flagship SHED lane
Emergency Buffers Over Time	Measurement note	SHED repeated cross-sections	Official benchmark and constructed diagnostics can be reconciled transparently	Final harmonization and variance estimates
Liquid Buffers, Borrowed Resilience, and Household Hardship Profiles	Working paper	SHED 2025 microdata + harmonized 2015–2025 validation	Main empirical SHED measurement contribution: bridge credit, revolving credit, emergency borrowing, inability to pay, and liquidity exclusion are distinct hardship profiles; first-pass data-driven clustering, benchmark screens, and public-use inference boundary now documented	Official design-consistent SHED inference if available, richer taxonomy validation, fuller data appendix and literature review
SHED Emergency-Buffer Measurement and Replication Note	Measurement note	SHED source/method documentation	Provenance, harmonization limits, benchmark diagnostics, variable map, public archive README, and	Exact wave codebook text extraction and final archive release decision

Document	Public status	Primary data posture	What is solid	What remains next
			checksum manifest are documented	
Economic Strain and Health Burden in U.S. States	Working paper	State-year panel	Rebuilt post-2011 panel with health/economic strain measures	Final manuscript polish and public-release polish
Mapping Household Financial Resilience	Published	Synthesis of public-data papers	Organizes the series into household channels: costs, buffers, debt, assets, labor, planning, and backstops	Update after public-library triage and microdata upgrades

Current publication boundary

The public site can include working drafts because the site is ours and can preserve clear boundaries. The rule is simple:

A working draft can be public if the page makes the status visible before the reader reaches the headline findings.

That means a working draft should have:

- a status label near the top;
- a short “what is solid / what is not final” box;
- plain-English caveats before technical caveats;
- no headline claims from exploratory diagnostic tables;
- links to methodology notes when available.

Near-term roadmap

1. Curate the public library

Keep the public surface organized by status and purpose. Do not let the research page become a file dump.

2. Harden replication notes

Build methodology notes for the highest-value public artifacts first:

1. SHED emergency-buffer work — archive scaffold now includes public README, variable map, and checksum manifest; next upgrade is clean-room rebuild and frozen release.
2. Paper IX / Fragility Premium — revised CEX appendix is public; next upgrade is repeated-cross-section CEX/MEPS and outcome validation, not more aggregate CPI polishing.
3. MEPS medical financial fragility working draft — the latest revision adds selected survey-design confidence intervals, family-construction checks, and PRPL linkage sensitivity.
4. Capstone synthesis source map.
5. Monetary-stress paper series source index.

3. Polish the capstone synthesis

The capstone is the best user-facing entry point once the library is curated. It should explain how the papers fit together rather than adding another chartbook.

4. Prioritize SHED microdata as the flagship empirical backbone

The SHED lane is now BTC Helper Research's strongest household-level empirical lane. Read the SHED sequence in layers: the published-indicator note motivates the buffer problem, the replication/harmonization notes document the data path, and the hardship-profile working draft develops the main measurement contribution. The likely consolidated flagship paper is: **Emergency Buffers, Borrowed Resilience, and Household Hardship: Evidence from SHED 2015–2025.**

5. Return to MEPS for the next validation pass

The MEPS working draft now includes a first round of public checks on uncertainty, family construction, and premium linkage. The next MEPS revision should broaden design-based inference to means, thresholds, and models; validate family construction against MEPS guidance; check PRPL premium annualization and documentation; and extend beyond 2022.

6. Maintain a living sound-money research roadmap

BTC Helper should always have at least one active public-data research lane, even at a slower cadence than the initial sprint. Prioritize depth, replication, and clear data paths over paper count.

7. Explore the BTC Helper Budgeting App / Household Resilience Planner

A future BTC Helper product lane should explore an open-access, privacy-forward budgeting tool that helps users translate the research into practical household resilience decisions. It should be separate from any private/local budgeting workflow, though it can borrow general design lessons.

Public trust rule

When in doubt, underclaim. A reader should always be able to tell whether a document is a polished public note, a working draft, a methodology note, or an exploratory diagnostic.